

Internal Glossary

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Atlas. The internal name for the S1 delivery outage in eu-fra on 14 November 2025, caused by an expired mTLS certificate. Named after the deploy immediately preceding it, which turned out to be entirely unrelated. Used as the reference example for postmortem format and depth.

Backlog. Undelivered events queued behind a failing or throttled endpoint. Distinct from the dead letter queue: a backlog will still be delivered, whereas dead lettered events will not be unless they are explicitly replayed.

Circuit breaker. Per-endpoint protection that stops delivery attempts when an endpoint is failing. Opens above a 50 percent failure rate over 60 seconds. Probes every 30 seconds while open.

Coverage zone. One of the three geographic windows in which support is staffed during local business hours.

DLQ. Dead letter queue. Where an event goes after its final retry attempt fails. Retained 14 days on every plan, Starter included.

Drain. The process of working through a backlog after the underlying failure is resolved. Drain throughput is higher than normal delivery throughput but is not unlimited.

Endpoint. A customer-owned HTTPS URL that Relay delivers to. Each endpoint has its own signing secret, its own circuit breaker, and its own dead letter queue.

Fair-share scheduler. The per-tenant queue partitioning shipped on 19 February 2026, ensuring one tenant's retry volume cannot delay another tenant's deliveries within a region.

Flush window. The period following a circuit breaker closing during which held events are delivered. Not a rate limit, though it is regularly mistaken for one by customers watching their inbound traffic.

Idempotency key. An optional client-supplied string that suppresses duplicate events within a 24 hour window.

Primary region. The region a tenant selects at signup, determining where their events are stored and from where deliveries originate. Changing it after signup is a manual operation and historical events do not migrate.

Region. One of eu-tll, eu-fra, us-iad, or ap-sin.

Relay. The core event delivery product, generally available since November 2020.

S1 to S4. Severity levels. S1 and S2 page immediately at any hour; S3 and S4 do not page and are triaged during working hours. Defined in full in the on-call document.

Shadow shift. A full seven day rotation in which an engineer receives every page but is responsible for responding to none. Required before joining the rotation.

Signal. The delivery observability add-on released in June 2024. Included on Scale and Enterprise, sold separately on Growth, and unavailable on Starter.

Source. Where events enter Relay, as opposed to an endpoint, which is where they leave.

Tenant. One customer account within one region. Used in engineering contexts where the word customer would be ambiguous, since a single customer may hold several tenants across several regions.

Vault. The secrets storage product. Sunset announced September 2025, new signups disabled October 2025, end of life 30 June 2026. Existing customers were notified individually and pointed at the migration guide.